Implement the 5 Most Common Uses of AI in HR

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Initiatives: Technologies and Markets; Transform HR through AI

The first wave of AI use cases in HR is focused on accelerating speed to delivery and improving employee experience. CHROs should reference this implementation guide for the top five most implemented AI use cases in HR so they can effectively assess, pilot, and operationalize these use cases and improve value.

Insights at a Glance

In 2025, enterprisewide AI investment strategies were primarily steered by three top objectives: Improve productivity (75%), reduce costs (55%), and increase revenue (39%). [1] HR functions mirrored this sentiment, with improved productivity (81%) and cost reduction (51%) as the top two outcomes they aimed to achieve through AI. [1]

As this data indicates, the initial phase of AI adoption in HR — "Wave 1" of HR AI use cases — has been characterized by a focus on transactional efficiency and task automation within HR, [2] and these use cases are already more well-established. The top five use cases that the majority of HR executives have successfully deployed or are actively rolling out are: [2]

1. Candidate Sourcing
2. Candidate Matching
3. Employee and Manager Self-Service Agents (Tier 0 to 1)
4. Personalized Learning
5. Workforce Planning

These initial implementations have been largely effective, with approximately 80% of HR leaders agreeing the use cases met or exceeded their anticipated outcomes. [2] This AI implementation guide supports CHROs in effectively implementing and yielding the benefits of these use cases by providing:

- Peer-verified use-case benchmarks
- The definition of the use case
- Key considerations at each step of the implementation journey
- Common pitfalls and critical actions
- Key stakeholders to involve
- Sample vendors providing the use case
- Real-life case studies from peers

Impact

AI is now a core component of HR technology and is accounted for in a median of 10% of HR 2025 functional budgets, with 82% of HR leaders planning to further increase AI investment in 2026. HR leaders are projected to spend on average $642,200 on AI in 2026. [1] See Infographic: AI's Impact on HR Budgets for more insights.

Over the past 12 months, as the AI solution market has matured and the pace of net-new AI capabilities has slowed slightly, many HR vendors have been assessing how to improve their initial solutions to establish a unique selling point over competitors.

As a result, CHROs should now be looking to adopt or implement AI solutions into their HR functions, but effective implementation of AI use cases remains paramount. Successful implementation will impact the use cases' ROI and ensure future AI funding doesn't get hindered.

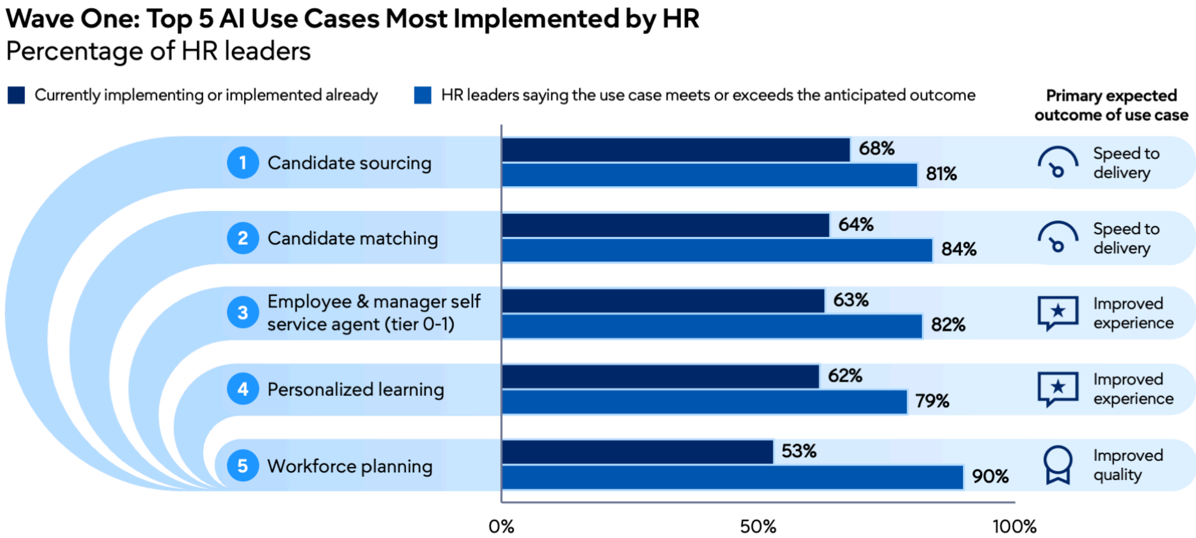
Actions

In a rapidly evolving space, CHROs who are looking to effectively implement Wave 1 AI use cases should focus on:

- Understanding which AI use cases their peers have implemented and how successful they have been at achieving their intended outcome (see Figure 1)

- Prioritizing use cases aligned to their organizational and functional needs
- Mitigating any implementation and adoption hurdles of their selected use cases to ensure their intended outcomes are achieved and AI investments don't become a sunk cost with low ROI

Figure 1: Wave One: Top 5 Use Cases Most Implemented by HR



n = 260 global HR leaders and executives
Q: Which of the following HR use cases has your HR function already deployed or plans to deploy AI capabilities in the future? For those you have already deployed, please indicate how long it has been since deployment.
Q: What is the primary expected outcome that your HR function is currently pursuing or planning to pursue with each AI use case?
Q: To what degree have the following implemented use cases achieved anticipated outcomes for your HR function?
Source: 2026 Gartner AI Implementation HR Leader Survey, conducted February-April 2026
856391

Gartner

This note is part of a series; please also see: How AI is Transforming the HR Function and Talent Initiatives and Emerging Uses of AI in HR: Implementing the Next Wave.

How to Execute

The vendors referenced are a sample selection of providers catering to each use case, either in part or in its entirety. The selections are presented in alphabetical order, are not exhaustive and should not be construed as an endorsement of any vendor, product, or service therein (see Note 1).

No. 1 Most Implemented Use Case: Candidate Sourcing

Data Insight: As of April 2026, candidate sourcing was either fully implemented or in the process of being implemented by 68% of HR leaders. [2] The primary expected outcome for HR leaders, as selected by 54%, was improved speed to delivery, and 81% of HR leaders stated the use case met or exceeded their anticipated outcome. [2]

Use-Case Definition: Candidate sourcing solutions use AI to source talent based on job requirements. Algorithms leverage inferred and related skills to identify qualified candidates in multiple talent pools, including internal candidates, prior applicants, and passive, external candidates.

Implementation Considerations:

- **Preimplementation:**
    - Survey cross-functional stakeholders across recruiting, HR, legal, compliance, and HRIT to pinpoint the exact operational problems AI will solve, such as improving quality of hire or cutting staffing agency spend.
    - Define clear legal guardrails and operational requirements before starting vendor evaluations.
    - Assess vendor capabilities on the quality and transparency of their AI algorithms; specifically, how accurately and fairly do they identify candidates for your job requirements?

- **Pilot Development:**
    - Select targeted pilot groups of recruiting teams, preferably for both niche/hard-to-fill roles and roles with high candidate volume, to validate that the sourcing vendor's recommendations will lead to intended outcomes and to test process adjustments.
    - Test sourcing algorithms in a controlled environment to measure their core effectiveness and organizational value before widespread scale.

- **Scale:**
  - Broaden the application of AI sourcing capabilities across a wider range of job functions, business units, and geographical regions.
  - Monitor engagement and use patterns among the recruiting team to drive consistent organizational adoption.
  - Gather qualitative feedback to identify successful sourcing outcomes and pinpoint specific role types where the tool remains less effective.
  - Reconfigure talent acquisition structures and process flows to maximize the operational flexibility gained from improved pipeline efficiency.
- **Postdeployment:**
  - Track critical metrics such as cost per hire (including deep dive into reduced agency spend), time to hire, offer acceptance rates, and direct recruiter feedback on usability.
  - Document outcomes and process changes carefully for long-term compliance and audit purposes.

Table 1: Common Pitfalls and Critical Actions for Candidate Sourcing

Common Pitfalls	Critical Actions
Emerging AI regulations and data privacy laws demand transparency.	Include legal/AI governance in vendor selection; ensure transparency on data and compliance.
The widespread adoption of candidate sourcing across organizations has led to a surge in outreach volumes, triggering heightened skepticism among candidates and potentially lowering response rates.	Upskill your recruiters on building authentic connections with candidates through personalized communications to overcome candidate skepticism.
Organizations vary in risk tolerance. Moving to AI sourcing requires higher risk maturity, clear responsible AI policies, and deep evaluation compared to simpler automation tasks.	Align AI sourcing with the talent acquisition strategy and set clear objectives before investing. Choose between augmented or agentic AI, noting that autonomous agents require rigorous testing.
Hiring teams must understand their roles alongside AI to keep a human-centric hiring process. Insufficient training or documentation causes poor adoption and a reliance on legacy tools.	Prioritize vendors demonstrating why candidates are identified. Periodically review outcomes, feedback, and fairness metrics to drive improvement.

Source: Gartner (August 2026)

Key Stakeholders: Sourcing specialists, talent acquisition recruiters, hiring managers, legal counsel, compliance leads, and enterprise risk management heads

Sample Vendors to Consider: Fetcher, Findem, Gem, hireEZ, Phenom, Rival, Seekout

> **Abano Healthcare**
>
> To support an always-on, AI-enabled sourcing model, Abano partnered with Leoforce to automate the identification, prescreening, and engagement of clinical candidates throughout global markets and time zones. Leoforce's Applicants on Demand solution continuously sources talent from job posting channels, runs targeted outreach campaigns, and engages candidates until they are ready to apply.

> Using AI targeting and curation, Leoforce replaces low-yield email blasts with tailored campaigns that identify candidates more likely to apply. Once engaged, qualified applicants are directly delivered into their applicant tracking system. Platform integration allows recruiters to seamlessly transition from sourcing to selection, reducing friction in the process.
>
> Source: AI Use Case and Best Practice Library for HR

No. 2 Most Implemented Use Case: Candidate Matching

Data Insight: As of April 2026, candidate matching was either fully implemented or in the process of being implemented by 64% of HR leaders. [2] The primary expected outcome for HR leaders, as selected by 54%, was improved speed to delivery, and 84% stated that the use case met or exceeded their anticipated outcome. [2]

Use-Case Definition: Candidate matching leverages advanced algorithms to analyze job requirements and candidate profiles to score or rank candidates for review by the recruitment team. Prioritizing qualified candidates at the top of the funnel streamlines the hiring process, reduces bias, and improves hiring accuracy.

Implementation Considerations:

- **Preimplementation:**
  - Meet with legal and compliance; AI governance; and diversity, equity, and inclusion teams to review the intended use of candidate matching features to ensure the process has the right level of rigor to mitigate risk; also include what is at risk if teams do not have access to these capabilities (e.g., inability to consider every candidate due to increased candidate volumes).
  - Establish a firm governance framework with expected deliverables regarding candidate data privacy, depth of algorithm (e.g., to include adjacent and related skills matches), and explainability in the form of AI summaries and reports that audit matching outcomes before evaluating matching vendor models.

- **Pilot Development:**
  - Test matching software recommendations against human recruiter shortlists to validate model accuracy and ensure fit scores genuinely reflect candidate suitability.
  - Identify the best-suited roles for candidate matching. These are typically positions that require experience and provide AI enough context to accurately score candidates against the position's requirements. Not every position is suited for candidate matching (e.g., early-career and very niche roles often should be excluded).

- **Scale:**
  - Integrate the use of candidate matching insights into core recruiter workflows to ensure recruiters are evaluating the AI summaries provided as an explanation of fit score for each candidate.
  - Reinforce expectations that recruiter evaluation is required prior to dispositioning candidates.

- **Postdeployment:**
  - Track critical metrics, including quality of candidate pool, time to hire, and direct recruiter feedback on usability.
  - Review quality of match scores and candidate demographic data at set audit intervals to check for algorithmic drift or systemic bias.

Table 2: Common Pitfalls and Critical Actions for Candidate Matching

(Enlarged table in Appendix)

Common Pitfalls	Critical Actions
Hiring teams — including recruiters and business partners — struggle to adapt to reviewing candidates alongside AI; there is a critical need to keep humans in the loop.	Maintain human oversight by involving recruiters in decision making and reviewing AI-driven recommendations.
Vendors offering limited transparency and model explainability create defensibility and compliance risks.	Prioritize solutions that leverage balanced datasets and explainable AI to model and transparently present outcomes to recruiters during candidate review.
Systems rely on large volumes of candidate data, raising concerns about how personal information is collected, stored, and used.	Ensure robust data privacy policies and security protocols that ensure candidate information is collected, stored, and used in compliance with relevant regulations.
Changing AI recruiting regulations make legal/compliance teams hesitant to support implementation.	Collaborate with legal and AI governance to discuss the risk of using versus not using AI in this capacity. Establish recruiter oversight in the process, regular audits, and model updates to mitigate bias and maintain accuracy.
Candidate matching effectiveness is diminished when applicants use generative AI (GenAI) to create resumes, as automated text inflates match scores.	Increase strategic rigor for key roles by using skills validation, simulations, and more in-depth interviews to identify genuine talent.

Source: Gartner (August 2026)

Key Stakeholders: Recruiters, hiring managers, talent acquisition leaders, and compliance specialists.

Sample Vendors to Consider: AdeptID, HiredScore (Workday), Sense, Textkernel by Bullhorn

> **Vanderlande**
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> Vanderlande integrated HiredScore into its existing Workday HCM system to facilitate candidate matching at scale. HiredScore's AI analyzes resumes and applicant profiles to extract skills, experiences, and qualifications, going beyond traditional keyword matching to assess role relevance. The system evaluates candidate fit in real time, scoring applicants based on how closely their profiles align with job requirements and highlighting those most likely to succeed, along with providing a summary of the matching results for recruiters to affirm.
>
> This capability is particularly valuable for experienced positions that garner a high volume of applicants. For hard-to-fill roles, Vanderlande also uses HiredScore's Fetch functionality to rediscover past applicants in its existing database and identify qualified candidates it might otherwise overlook. HiredScore's AI matching reduces manual effort and ensures the focus is placed on the most qualified candidates.
>
> Source: AI Use Case and Best Practice Library for HR

No. 3 Most Considered Use Case: Employee and Manager Self-Service Agents (Tier 0 to 1)

Data Insight: As of April 2026, employee and manager self-service agent (Tier 0 to 1) was either fully implemented or in the process of being implemented by 63% of HR leaders. [2] The primary expected outcome, as selected by 55%, was improved experience, and 82% of HR leaders stated that the use case met or exceeded their anticipated outcome. [2]

Use-Case Definition: AI agents are autonomous or semiautonomous software entities that use AI techniques to perceive, make decisions, take actions, and achieve goals in their digital or physical environments. AI agents for employee and manager self-service execute HR tasks and services for end users through multimodal human-machine interactions via smartphone, tablet, computer, or other specific devices.

Implementation Considerations:

- **Preimplementation:**
  - Assess vendors thoroughly on their capacity to leverage AI for enhancing HR service agent productivity, efficiency, and service delivery while simultaneously improving the user experience.
  - Work closely with HR leadership to determine precise business objectives, service management scope, and technology requirements to ensure targets are met without overbuying infrastructure.
  - Coordinate with IT to align self-service agent architecture with enterprise AI. Collaborate across service organizations (IT, finance, purchasing) to create a unified vision and single point of entry for a cohesive employee service experience if possible.
  - Conduct an inventory and remap processes to make room for AI agents, including the assessment of internal data structures and workflows to ensure they are fully ready for the deployment of autonomous agents.
  - Verify the agent's back-end infrastructure complies with internal data privacy policies and any regional regulatory requirements associated with employee data.

- Pilot Development:
  - Pilot a prebuilt agent in a controlled environment to measure its effectiveness and value before committing to more widespread agent adoption.
  - Assess the agent's parameters and consider key gaps that may arise from any AI agent gaps or operational failures.
  - Incorporate sentiment analysis to assess emotional tone and urgency, enabling more empathetic and prioritized support pathways.
- Scale:
  - Decide whether to use off-the-shelf solutions versus deploying solutions that can be built or blended with preexisting solutions.
  - Plan to resolve low-to-moderate complexity queries through automation first, starting with easy transactions and building in operational complexity over time.
  - Deploy conversational platforms natively as plug-ins within workstream collaboration hubs such as Slack and Microsoft Teams.
- Postdeployment:
  - Leverage an advanced business intelligence layer featuring AI-powered analytics to trace continuous process routing and failure outcomes.
  - Monitor context-aware autonomous actions and use large language model (LLM)-generated recommendations on agentic dashboards to map issue clusters.
  - Focus on ongoing AI agent management including (re)tuning, ongoing customization, and retraining needs based on user feedback.

Table 3: Common Pitfalls and Critical Actions for Employee and Manager Self-Service Agents (Tier 0 to 1)

(Enlarged table in Appendix)

Common Pitfalls	Critical Actions
Attempting to fully automate sensitive or highly volatile employee relations, disciplinary actions, and grievance management cases that require human empathy and oversight can lead to inadequate handling of these issues.	Mark employee relations and grievance management cases exempt from autonomous AI execution beyond basic initial categorization and template support to guarantee proper human oversight.
Data privacy and access vulnerabilities can become exposed if HR fails to establish strict information boundaries. This can result in the unauthorized exposure of sensitive HR data, compensation details, or personally identifiable information to the wrong user categories.	Ensure proper implementation of role-based access control so agents only provide information meant to be accessible to that specific end-user category, and maintain a necessary audit trail.
Technical complexities such as legacy system silos and fragmented data integration directly hinder the underlying accuracy and reliability of autonomous workflow execution.	In the short term, consider the key integrations required to enable effective service delivery for the workflows that traverse multiple systems. In the longer term, focus on greater interoperability of HR technology systems and/or a data lake approach.
High internal adoption may become hindered if HR teams fail to properly manage the cultural shift toward agentic capabilities or lag in acquiring required digital skills.	Fund and implement comprehensive data and AI literacy programs across all employee groups to enable human-AI collaboration. In addition, adjust employee expectations around service delivery when Tier 0 and Tier 1 employee and manager self-service isn't reset.

Source: Gartner (August 2026)

Key Stakeholders: Employees, managers, HR shared services teams, legal teams, enterprise risk management, and corporate IT partners.

Sample Vendors to Consider: Druid AI, Kore.ai, Microsoft, Salesforce, ServiceNow

> Mercado Libre
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> Mercado Libre developed a conversational GenAI virtual assistant called People Chat to facilitate employee self-service of nearly all HR queries and transactions. People Chat is integrated into Google Chat, which is the company's daily work environment, communication, and collaboration tool. As opposed to the rule-based bot that required several clicks for employees to achieve results, People Chat allows employees to leverage iterative, conversational GenAI that resolves their query successfully 95% of the time. This success is due to the rigor Mercado Libre put into the delivery. The company spent four months training People Chat for accuracy, building an architecture that correctly identifies employee needs. Mercado Libre also piloted People Chat with 10,000 employees to improve its answers before a companywide rollout five months later. It successfully assisted with approximately 1.4 million queries and generated $2.7 million in savings.
>
> Source: AI Use Case and Best Practice Library for HR

No. 4 Most Considered Use Case: Personalized Learning

Data Insight: As of April 2026, personalized learning was either fully implemented or in the process of being implemented by 62% of HR leaders. [2] The primary expected outcome for HR leaders, as selected by 62%, was improved experience, and 79% stated that the use case met or exceeded their anticipated outcome. [2]

Use-Case Definition: Use AI to personalize learning through tailored learning paths, adaptive content, skill-building simulations, and timely nudges. This AI use case leverages data on learner behavior and interests to enable personalization of learning for employees.

Implementation Considerations:

- **Preimplementation:**
  - Leverage foundational skills intelligence to delineate the core capabilities necessary for navigating organizational roles.
  - Standardize and tag existing job architectures and learning assets with precise skills data to facilitate accurate AI-driven development matching.
  - Collaborate and align with other business units within the enterprise, such as IT and sales, to develop a unified, shared vision for the overall learner and employee experience.
  - Assess vendor capabilities on the quality and transparency of their AI algorithms — specifically, how accurately they match employee talent profiles, skills, and development needs (i.e., learning paths) with proper content for activities, tasks, and job requirements.
- **Pilot Development:**
  - Select a targeted pilot group to test personalization capabilities. Organizations most often initiate pilots in sales or IT to start to validate personalized recommendations for these audiences for both technical and soft skills training.
  - Assess prebuilt agents in a controlled environment with a sample audience to measure their core effectiveness and organizational value before enterprise rollout.

- **Scale:**
  - Follow the 70-20-10 model for learning pathways to allocate learning time effectively, dedicating 70% of a learner's time to experiential learning, 20% to social learning, and 10% to formal or book learning.
  - Integrate learning platforms natively with enterprise systems of record and workstream collaboration tools to drive usage and maximize adoption.
- **Postdeployment:**
  - Track critical learning metrics including learner satisfaction, time to productivity, and talent mobility to gauge impact(s) of personalized learning at scale.

Table 4: Common Pitfalls and Critical Actions for Personalized Learning

Common Pitfalls	Critical Actions
Relying on traditional linear career paths that no longer suit today's dynamic workplace can lead to learner frustration or misalignment between acquired skills and business applicability.	Implement an agile mindset for skills development through short bursts of real-time iterative learning and just-in-time microbursts that combine short lesson chunks with immediate applied learning experiences.
Siloed learning environments can arise by treating development as an isolated, individual task while ignoring peer-to-peer knowledge sharing, which limits collaborative growth and causes insular knowledge to stay trapped in silos.	Reinforce individual development efforts through social learning techniques, such as encouraging employees to teach what they know and actively participate in internal communities of practice.
Experiential stagnation can arise by confining employees strictly to comfortable, familiar responsibilities out of fear of operational risk, which delays hands-on capability building until after a critical need arises.	Encourage employees to take on stretch assignments, meaning projects or initiatives beyond their current skill level, to gain practical experiential learning ahead of organizational demand.

Source: Gartner (August 2026)

Key Stakeholders: Learning and development leaders, instructional designers, managers, employees, and corporate IT partners.

Sample Vendors to Consider: 360Learning, Absorb Software, Cornerstone, Degreed, Docebo, Thrive, Sana (Workday)

BT Group

> L&D leaders began the transformation by creating a skills taxonomy mapped to 600 core roles. In 2024, using Degreed's Automations tool, the company rolled out an AI-enhanced learning experience platform called My Campus. The platform leverages AI to aggregate content from providers such as Pluralsight, Coursera, and LinkedIn Learning — alongside proprietary BT Group materials — to deliver personalized recommendations based on employees' roles, preferences, and behavior. The Automations tool further personalizes learning journeys by automatically delivering content through nudges and tailored learning journeys for each business unit, eliminating manual training assignments. My Campus integrates with SuccessFactors to share skills data in a single system of record. Employees can also access learning content within Microsoft Teams, which helps to increase adoption.
>
> Source: AI Use Case and Best Practice Library for HR

No. 5 Most Considered Use Case: Workforce Planning

Data Insight: As of April 2026, workforce planning was either fully implemented or in the process of being implemented by 53% of HR leaders. [2] The primary expected outcome, as selected by 50%, was improved quality, and 90% of HR leaders stated that the use case met or exceeded their anticipated outcome. [2]

Use-Case Definition: AI techniques forecast workforce demands, create scenarios and simulations, track and infer skills, and assess external labor market trends.

Implementation Considerations:

- **Preimplementation:**
    - Identify and communicate talent risks early to properly inform CHRO strategy decisions.
    - Work with business leaders to design optimized roles that naturally attract top talent using targeted market insights.
    - Perform a comprehensive skills inventory and gap analysis through a variety of methods, including surveys, employee interviews, and feedback from performance reviews.
    - Use external labor market data and insights to guide strategic workforce planning regarding roles, skills, locations, and hiring timelines.

- **Pilot Development:**
  - Launch initial proof-of-concept simulation models within restricted functional or technical domains to iteratively tune model inference parameters before broad deployment.

- **Scale:**
  - Integrate skills intelligence systems cleanly across core enterprise layers, including workforce planning platforms, learning experience platforms, and talent acquisition suites.

- **Postdeployment:**
  - Leverage external labor market intelligence taxonomies to continuously benchmark internal capacity trends against broader emerging industry shifts.

Table 5: Common Pitfalls and Critical Actions for Workforce Planning

(Enlarged table in Appendix)

Common Pitfalls	Critical Actions
Business, finance, and HR leaders have disparate perspectives on workforce planning. HR lacks a leadership position, limiting strategic application.	Engage with business leaders and executives to prioritize the workforce questions you need to answer, which dictates your solutions approach.
Uneven data maturity limits headcount reporting, while disparate regional payrolls hinder personnel cost planning.	Start workforce planning with critical segments, such as hard-to-resource roles, before attempting a full global rollout.
No single workforce planning technology solution on the market can support all various forms of workforce planning.	Invest in a portfolio of technologies (rather than a single cure-all tool) to support your most critical workforce planning activities.
Organizations face technical difficulties integrating workforce planning software with existing legacy HR, payroll, finance, or business systems.	Directly connect workforce planning to financial planning and analysis through extended planning and analysis to bridge the system and departmental gap.
Enterprises risk permanent skills gaps in vital roles from skills erosion, poor pay, or passive career management.	Replace rigid career paths with flexible lattices that enable vertical, horizontal, and diagonal growth aligned with evolving employee skills.
Skill overspecialization limits corporate agility and cross-functional collaboration.	Create a versatile workforce using multidisciplinary assignments and job rotations to share synthesized knowledge across technical silos.

Source: Gartner (August 2026)

Key Stakeholders: Strategic workforce planners, corporate planning executives, HR business partners, business unit leaders, and data managers.

Sample Vendors to Consider: Albert, eQ8, Lightcast, Orgvue, SkyHive (Cornerstone), TalentNeuron, TechWolf

> HSBC
>
> HSBC partnered with vendor TechWolf to build an AI-driven skills intelligence system. The platform uses LLMs to automatically infer skills from multiple employee data sources, including HR systems, Jira, GitHub, Bitbucket, and artifacts such as emails and internal documents. During the proof-of-concept phase, HSBC and TechWolf iteratively tuned the models until they could infer 80% of employee skills automatically, which reduced manual effort and maintenance. TechWolf then deployed an AI-generated taxonomy that consolidated 4,000 to 5,000 skills into roughly 300 skills packages aligned to HSBC's job architecture. The system serves as a data provider, feeding skills insights into HSBC's workforce planning platforms, as well as learning and talent acquisition systems. The system now supports a talent marketplace, digital badging and on-the-job development opportunities across the bank.
>
> Source: AI Use Case and Best Practice Library for HR

How to Articulate Value

To articulate the value realized from the use cases, here are some sample metrics HR leaders can consider based on the primary expected outcome of the use case:

- **Speed of task completion in AI-augmented workflows:** This metric measures how much faster employees can complete core business tasks when supported by AI tools, compared to traditional/manual workflows.
  - **How to calculate:** This is the average time taken to complete a defined set of tasks with AI support versus without. Calculate the percentage reduction in task completion time across matched cohorts or pre-/post-AI implementation. An increase in task completion time may indicate a problem in AI implementation.

- **Employee engagement index:** This is a survey-based index capturing employees' emotional commitment and intent to stay; it reflects how motivated employees are to go above baseline requirements in their roles.
  - **How to calculate:** Aggregate responses from validated engagement surveys, generating a composite score or index; track changes over time or across cohorts.

- **AI error rate:** This measures the percentage of tasks or transactions in which AI tools produce inaccurate, incomplete, or unintended outputs within business workflows. Lower rates signal higher reliability and maturity.
    - **How to calculate:** Number of tasks with identified AI errors divided by total number of AI-driven tasks in a set period; express this as a percentage and track trends over time or across functions.

Contributors

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Evidence

Note 1: Sample Vendor Selection

The sample vendors are compiled at the analyst's discretion. They represent those already identified in other publications (including Hype Cycle, Market Guide) and/or reflect those in which Gartner has received the most client interest (via searches on Gartner.com and inquiry).

[1] 2026 Gartner C-Suite AI Survey. This survey was conducted to understand how enterprises are approaching AI, including budget allocations, current state of implementation and impact, AI strategy, and use cases across key business functions. The functions covered in the survey include finance (n = 160), HR (n = 135), procurement (n = 134), supply chain (n = 135), marketing (n = 154), sales (n = 135), customer service (n = 95), IT (n = 161), product management (n = 59) and legal/risk/compliance (n = 135); legal subfunction (n = 84), compliance subfunction (n = 31). The research was conducted online from January through April 2026 among 1,303 respondents across various industries and regions, including North America (n = 671), EMEA (n = 425), Asia/Pacific (n = 141), LATAM (n = 65), and others (n = 1). Qualifying organizations reported enterprisewide annual revenue of at least $50 million (or equivalent) in fiscal year 2025. Participants were required to be either the most senior leader or one level below the most senior leader within their respective function, and have familiarity with AI strategy, implementation, and budget for that function. Disclaimer: The results of this survey do not represent global findings or the market as a whole, but reflect the sentiments of the respondents and companies surveyed.

[2] The 2026 Gartner AI Implementation HR Leader Survey was conducted to identify high-value AI use cases, outline best practices and ROI quantified through metrics such as time saved, cost reductions, headcount efficiencies, and improvements in employee experience. The research was conducted online from February 2026 to April 2026 among 260 HR leaders with representation from various geographies and industries. Respondents were screened for being one or two layers away from the most senior HR executive in the organization, and being the primary leader for any of the HR subfunctions like Talent Management, Recruiting, Learning and Development, HR Technology, or Total Rewards. Disclaimer: The results of this survey do not represent global findings or the market as a whole, but reflect the sentiments of the respondents and companies surveyed.

Disclaimer: The organization (or organizations) profiled in this research is (or are) provided for illustrative purposes only, and does (or do) not constitute an exhaustive list of examples in this field nor an endorsement by Gartner of the organization or its offerings.

Recommended by the Authors

Some documents may not be available as part of your current Gartner subscription.

Tool: AI Maturity Assessment for HR

Tool: AI Roadmap for HR

How AI Is Transforming the HR Function and Talent Initiatives

Emerging Uses of AI in HR: Implementing the Next Wave

Table 1: Common Pitfalls and Critical Actions for Candidate Sourcing

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Emerging AI regulations and data privacy laws demand transparency.	Include legal/AI governance in vendor selection; ensure transparency on data and compliance.
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Organizations vary in risk tolerance. Moving to AI sourcing requires higher risk maturity, clear responsible AI policies, and deep evaluation compared to simpler automation tasks.	Align AI sourcing with the talent acquisition strategy and set clear objectives before investing. Choose between augmented or agentic AI, noting that autonomous agents require rigorous testing.
Hiring teams must understand their roles alongside AI to keep a human-centric hiring process. Insufficient training or documentation causes poor adoption and a reliance on legacy tools.	Prioritize vendors demonstrating why candidates are identified. Periodically review outcomes, feedback, and fairness metrics to drive improvement.

Source: Gartner (August 2026)

Table 2: Common Pitfalls and Critical Actions for Candidate Matching

Common Pitfalls	Critical Actions
Hiring teams — including recruiters and business partners — struggle to adapt to reviewing candidates alongside AI; there is a critical need to keep humans in the loop.	Maintain human oversight by involving recruiters in decision making and reviewing AI-driven recommendations.
Vendors offering limited transparency and model explainability create defensibility and compliance risks.	Prioritize solutions that leverage balanced datasets and explainable AI to model and transparently present outcomes to recruiters during candidate review.
Systems rely on large volumes of candidate data, raising concerns about how personal information is collected, stored, and used.	Ensure robust data privacy policies and security protocols that ensure candidate information is collected, stored, and used in compliance with relevant regulations.
Changing AI recruiting regulations make legal/compliance teams hesitant to support implementation.	Collaborate with legal and AI governance to discuss the risk of using versus not using AI in this capacity. Establish recruiter oversight in the process, regular audits, and model updates to mitigate bias and maintain accuracy.
Candidate matching effectiveness is diminished when applicants use generative AI (GenAI) to create resumes, as automated text inflates match scores.	Increase strategic rigor for key roles by using skills validation, simulations, and more in-depth interviews to identify genuine talent.

Source: Gartner (August 2026)

Table 3: Common Pitfalls and Critical Actions for Employee and Manager Self-Service Agents (Tier 0 to 1)

Common Pitfalls	Critical Actions
Attempting to fully automate sensitive or highly volatile employee relations, disciplinary actions, and grievance management cases that require human empathy and oversight can lead to inadequate handling of these issues.	Mark employee relations and grievance management cases exempt from autonomous AI execution beyond basic initial categorization and template support to guarantee proper human oversight.
Data privacy and access vulnerabilities can become exposed if HR fails to establish strict information boundaries. This can result in the unauthorized exposure of sensitive HR data, compensation details, or personally identifiable information to the wrong user categories.	Ensure proper implementation of role-based access control so agents only provide information meant to be accessible to that specific end-user category, and maintain a necessary audit trail.
Technical complexities such as legacy system silos and fragmented data integration directly hinder the underlying accuracy and reliability of autonomous workflow execution.	In the short term, consider the key integrations required to enable effective service delivery for the workflows that traverse multiple systems. In the longer term, focus on greater interoperability of HR technology systems and/or a data lake approach.
High internal adoption may become hindered if HR teams fail to properly manage the cultural shift toward agentic capabilities or lag in acquiring required digital skills.	Fund and implement comprehensive data and AI literacy programs across all employee groups to enable human-AI collaboration. In addition, adjust employee expectations around service delivery when Tier 0 and Tier 1 employee and manager self-service isn't reset.

Source: Gartner (August 2026)

Table 4: Common Pitfalls and Critical Actions for Personalized Learning

Common Pitfalls	Critical Actions
Relying on traditional linear career paths that no longer suit today's dynamic workplace can lead to learner frustration or misalignment between acquired skills and business applicability.	Implement an agile mindset for skills development through short bursts of real-time iterative learning and just-in-time microbursts that combine short lesson chunks with immediate applied learning experiences.
Siloed learning environments can arise by treating development as an isolated, individual task while ignoring peer-to-peer knowledge sharing, which limits collaborative growth and causes insular knowledge to stay trapped in silos.	Reinforce individual development efforts through social learning techniques, such as encouraging employees to teach what they know and actively participate in internal communities of practice.
Experiential stagnation can arise by confining employees strictly to comfortable, familiar responsibilities out of fear of operational risk, which delays hands-on capability building until after a critical need arises.	Encourage employees to take on stretch assignments, meaning projects or initiatives beyond their current skill level, to gain practical experiential learning ahead of organizational demand.

Source: Gartner (August 2026)

Table 5: Common Pitfalls and Critical Actions for Workforce Planning

Common Pitfalls	Critical Actions
Business, finance, and HR leaders have disparate perspectives on workforce planning. HR lacks a leadership position, limiting strategic application.	Engage with business leaders and executives to prioritize the workforce questions you need to answer, which dictates your solutions approach.
Uneven data maturity limits headcount reporting, while disparate regional payrolls hinder personnel cost planning.	Start workforce planning with critical segments, such as hard-to-resource roles, before attempting a full global rollout.
No single workforce planning technology solution on the market can support all various forms of workforce planning.	Invest in a portfolio of technologies (rather than a single cure-all tool) to support your most critical workforce planning activities.
Organizations face technical difficulties integrating workforce planning software with existing legacy HR, payroll, finance, or business systems.	Directly connect workforce planning to financial planning and analysis through extended planning and analysis to bridge the system and departmental gap.
Enterprises risk permanent skills gaps in vital roles from skills erosion, poor pay, or passive career management.	Replace rigid career paths with flexible lattices that enable vertical, horizontal, and diagonal growth aligned with evolving employee skills.
Skill overspecialization limits corporate agility and cross-functional collaboration.	Create a versatile workforce using multidisciplinary assignments and job rotations to share synthesized knowledge across technical silos.

Source: Gartner (August 2026)